Dark Touch — Audio and Music

Part of the Dark Touch GDD. Decisions only; open points are in Open questions.

Music

- **Style:** dark neoclassical. **The cello is always the lead melody.** Mood reference: Requiem for Wonderland by Nox Cantabile.
- **Phonk elements to experiment with:** slowed phonk rhythms and deep bass under the strings. Reference: Dark Phonk String Quartet Vol.22, but with the cello kept as the lead melody. The best mix will be found by testing.
- **Adaptive layers:** the music changes with the situation: exploration, combat, boss.
- **Signature raise sound:** raising a soldier plays an iconic cello motif. It is a key part of the game's identity.
- **Production:** tracks are created with AI tools by the Music Director agent and iterated with the designer until validated. References are mood boards only, never reused audio.

Sound effects

- Sourced from free, **commercial-safe** sound banks only: CC0, Pixabay license, or CC-BY with credits.
- Found by the Sound Designer agent and reviewed on the Dark Touch Sound Board: 3 candidates per sound, pick one or ask for 3 more.
- How each action sounds and feels together with its visuals is specified by the Game Feel Director.